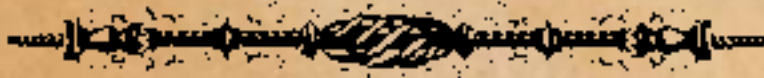


Please Join Us For

A Knight of Murder



Hear ye! Hear ye!
All ye Kings and Queens,
Knights and Nobles!

A tournament celebration is planned to honor the noble marriage of Baron Bartholomew to Lady Diana of Dunnsberry in the manor of Fernwood. As a resident of the manor, you are not only invited to be there, but your attendance is required by the request of your lord.

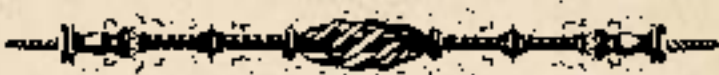
Whether it is to see knights jousting or to partake in the ale and entertainment, your business is but your own... that is until you find yourself in the middle of a murder.

With only one night to find the guilty, you will soon figure out that there is a lot more at stake, for murder in the manor is punishable by death. Whether you are guilty or not, there will be others trying to finger you as the culprit as you try to find the real murderer, and only you can defend your innocence. Whom do you trust? Who will betray you before the night is through? Everyone is a suspect and no one is safe in this mystery of medieval madness.

Be careful in attending.
Your life will depend not only
on your innocence,
but your ability to defend it.



Join us for an evening of mystery & mayhem in the Middle Ages



Rules in the Manor of Fernwood

Whether this is your first murder mystery experience or your fortieth, each murder mystery experience is different and has different rules pertaining. Here are some tips to make sure this evening is an unforgettable experience.

Read Your Character Sheet—This contains your identity and all the information you will need to play your part.

Don't Reveal Everything About Your Character—While there are many things that everyone needs to know about you, there are some things that should remain secret. Use your discretion to not give too much away-- you may find out at the party that you are the killer indeed!

Dress The Part— It's a proven fact that the more into character you are the easier it will be for you to truly enjoy all the aspects of the night. It also adds to the excitement, the photo opps, and your chance to be voted best dressed. Please see www.nightofmystery.com for ideas on costuming.

Review the Announcements—Included in this invite will be manor announcements. Review this page, it includes background information (such as the other characters attending), which may come in useful the night of the party.

Use Your Money Creatively—Upon arrival, you will receive gold coins to spend any way you choose. Bribery and blackmail are two of the most common uses we found (and highly encouraged). The wealthiest player at the end of the night will also receive an award for their ability to turn a profit.

Visit www.aknightofmurder.com for more information on the mystery!

Hear Ye! Hear Ye!

It is by decree of the lord and lady of Fernwood that the people of the manor are invited and ordered to attend the noble marriage of their son, **Baron Bartholomew**, to **Lady Diana of Dunnsberry**. The wedding is to take place on **December Second**, the one year anniversary of their meeting. A tournament of jousting pleasure is to follow to commemorate this momentous occasion in which the victorious knight will be awarded many riches plus the lady of his choice as escort for the celebration that night. Those expected to be in attendance are as follows:

Queen Genevieve-Queen. As ruler of this prosperous kingdom, Genevieve is well liked by everyone. It's hard to have many enemies when the punishment of betrayal is death!

Lord Taylor-Lord of the Manor. In celebration of his only son's marriage to the noblewoman of his choosing, Lord Taylor is determined to host a tournament of epic proportions.

Lady Gwendolyn-Lady of the Manor. Gwendolyn is delighted for the approaching tournament. To Gwendolyn, the celebration symbolizes prosperity and happiness and a chance to marry off her only son to another noble.

Baron Bartholomew-Son to the lord and lady. The tournament is planned in honor of his marriage to another noble on the one year anniversary of his and Diana's meeting. Baron's only regret is that he must marry for wealth instead of love.

Lady Diana of Dunnsberry-Noblewoman. Diana arrived in Fernwood on a quest for a husband. While her heart is now satisfied, another's may now be broken.

Maid Marilyn-Lady-In-Waiting. As Lady Gwendolyn's right-hand woman, Marilyn is like a daughter to the lady. Like a true mother, Gwendolyn will do anything to ensure Marilyn's happiness.

Sir Cameron-Knight. Sir Cameron is looking forward to entertaining and fighting for his honor in the manor tournament. If Cameron wins, rumor is that he will be asking for the favor of Maid Marilyn.

Sir Rufus-Knight. Sir Rufus is looking to boost his unfavorable reputation in the manor lands with a victory over Sir Cameron in the tournament. A triumph will not only win him the favor of a maid, but the popularity which that desires.

Joking Jerry-Court Jester. Jerry is commissioned to make everyone laugh. But at what cost does a laugh turn deadly?

Willie the Watchman-Manor Watchperson. As the guardian for the lord and his manor lands, Willie will be the force that keeps anyone from getting out of hand at the tournament.

Charlamagne-Chambermaid. Occupying the lowest tier of servant-hood in the castle, Charlamagne has unlimited access to all areas of the castle—a privilege others do not possess. While Charlamagne's knowledge of the intimate sections of the castle may be to her advantage, they may also be her ticket to trouble.

Maid Monica-Maid. Since Monica has always caught the Baron's eye (and heart), she assumed a marriage was impending. While Monica's marriage has been arranged, it is not to the person she desires.

Other announcements by the lord: An arranged marriage between **Sir Rufus** to **Maid Monica** to take place next month. Anyone not attending the wedding and celebration will be considered a traitor and will be banished from the manor.

Laws of the Land

As set forth by Queen Genevieve on how his kingdom is to be ruled

I. Betrayal of the queen is punishable by death!!!

II. The lord's word is law in his manor

- a. The only person who can overrule a lord is the queen.
- b. A manor consists of a castle, church and the surrounding lands granted to the lord by the queen.

III. Everyone that makes earnings must tithe a percentage of their earnings to the queen

- a. Percentages are set by the queen.
- b. Tithes (taxes) are collected by Sir Rufus in compliance with the wishes of the queen.

IV. The manor is to be run with a system as follows:

- a. Lords & Ladies—granted land from the queen and may run the manor as they see fit. They award land to the vassals and knights in exchange for protection from invaders. Among their duties are arranging marriages within their manor and administering justice.
- b. Vassals & Knights—are awarded land from the nobles of the manor. They are free to farm the land or pay peasants to do so. They may also have serfs that live on and farm their land.
- c. Peasants—often live in huts outside the castle walls and work on land owned by vassals or knights for a percentage of the profits. They still have their freedom, but own no land.
- d. Serfs—they are slaves to the lord for life. They farm the land for food and shelter, they are not allowed to have earthly possessions and in order to gain any freedom, they must escape and live one year plus one day in another manor. They are never required to fight, but are guaranteed protection from invaders. They need permission to marry.

V. Tournaments are to be a time of great celebration

- a. To be held to honor such events as coronation, a noble marriage or to boost the economy of a manor.
- b. The victorious knight may request the favor of any lady at the celebration. She will then be his escort for the evening.

Sir Rufus

You are a knight in the manor of Fernwood. After traveling throughout the lands, you have recently made Fernwood your home, not because of its prosperity, but because it is so secluded that no one has heard of you and your dastardly ways. Before Fernwood, you traveled to many manors, but were not liked in most of them because of your corrupt ways and illegal doings. Despite what the knight code would suggest, you are not a gallant or courageous knight, and you are glad that no one in Fernwood has realized that just yet.

Rather, no one knows of your despicable ways that can go on the record with the lord or the queen, and that is because you have threatened their families. Since replanting yourself in Fernwood, you have tried to gain favor with the queen by taking over the duties of collecting the queen's tax money – 10% of the earnings of the vassals and peasants. Recently, you increased the percentage of earnings tithed to 15%. This increase caused a great number of the families to have trouble paying. To ensure their payments were on time and in full, you have threatened the lives of many peasant families when they don't agree to pay up. Luckily for the families, so far all of them have paid. Additionally, you have warned the families that if they tell of your demonic behavior to the lord (Lord Taylor) or queen (Queen Genevieve), they will suffer at your hands.

Even though you have increased the taxes, due to the profits you have been keeping for yourself, the queen has noticed a drop in the riches he is receiving. To cover your tracks, you have blamed the lack of profitability in the manor. To Queen Genevieve (the queen), you have explained that Lord Taylor is simply not doing his job and thus the people of the manor have less earnings to give to the queen. With your explanation, you are hoping that Queen Genevieve will see that she has chosen a poor leader and will award you rule of the manor instead. In order to make this happen, you must be able to convince Queen Genevieve that Lord Taylor is not fit to run a peaceful and profitable manor. Additionally, you will need to make sure that the queen does not find out that you are behind the stolen money because she will never award the manor to someone who betrayed her.

In order to make a good name for yourself in Fernwood, you must win the jousting tournament that is being held in honor of the noble marriage between Baron Bartholomew (the baron) and Lady Diana of Dunnsberry (a noblewoman). You have tried your hardest to stay away from Lady Diana so that she will not recognize you as the knight that was banished from her manor (Dunnsberry) two years ago. Even though you have not seen Diana in some time, you believe she looks quite different.

At the tournament, you are scheduled to fight Sir Cameron, a favorite of the kingdom. Since Sir Cameron has a reputation for great fighting skills, you decided to try to increase your odds at winning. First, you drugged Sir Cameron's horse, Stallion. Next, you convinced Charlamagne (the chambermaid) to sneak into Sir Cameron's room and alter his armor so that Sir Cameron would be easier to defeat. Charlamagne did this under the assumption that you would make her your escort at the tournament party, another promise you don't intend to keep. Although you are aware that Charlamagne fancies you, you do not return her affections. In order to win popularity with the nobles, you intend to ask Maid Marilyn (the lady-in-waiting) for her favor as an escort when you win the tournament.

As the tournament celebration approaches, you are happy to attend. At the party you are looking forward to basking in the glory of victory and enhancing your popularity in the kingdom.

Acting and Dressing Your Part: Although you are evil down to your bone, you do not want others to regard you this way. Try to uphold the gallant image of a knight by acting accordingly at the party. In your own time, you let your real colors show. Come dressed as the valiant knight that you portray. Do not forget your armor, sword, helmet and shield. *For more information, including on ideas on how to dress, who will be at the party, some old English words to use, etc., please see the party tips page at www.nightofmystery.com or www.aknightofmurder.com*